

when you add up all the peripherals and they're not that powerful when you compare them to the competition. If we accept these criticisms at face value, we have to ask ourselves - where did they cut corners? Lets begin with accepting the first criticisms - Raspberry Pi's are not that cheap - true. Apart from the top-tier USD 35 dollar expense on the new Pi 2, when you begin adding up the costs of USB keyboard, mouse, HDMI-screen, WiFi dongle, Ethernet cable, HDMI cable, Pi case, speakers, external storage and a USB hub, you can easily end up spending nearly USD 300 on putting together your Pi computer system. The second criticism is also true - the power and capacity of the fully assembled Pi computer system can easily be outdone by something as basic as a generation old Chromebook. But both these criticisms are irrelevant because they miss the point of the Pi as a different type of computer. It would be like criticizing the Space Shuttle for giving really bad mileage on Indian national highways.

The reason for the cheapness of the Pi and its spartan setup isn't a deficiency, it is a feature. The Raspberry Pi never claimed to be an alternative to home computers like laptops and tablets. First and foremost, it is worth remembering that the company that designs and releases the Pi - Raspberry Foundation - is a not-for-profit educational organisation based in the United Kingdom.

This means that they do not hoard and profit-share the revenue from the millions of units they sell. The Foundation is rooted in its vision statement, which is to make computer literacy within the reach of children and schools. By limiting the functionality and components of their product they are able to keep the costs low, and allow integration of their device with existing IT infrastructure in schools and universities. However, the fame of the Raspberry Pi has come from well-funded independent projects by people across the world who find appeal in its form-factor and versatility. There "makers" use their ingenuity to make unique, customised and useful projects on the Raspberry Pi. Many inventors like the convenience of using the Raspberry Pi for quickly and cheaply prototyping their projects. All of this exists outside the primary domain of the mandate that the Raspberry Foundation started out with.

The status of the Raspberry Foundation as an educational non-profit is another reason they are able to keep the costs low, since they do not have to bear expenses which private technology firms endure. They, in fact, enjoy the support from companies like Broadcom (where a co-founder works) to get significantly lower rates on their SoCs and chips. This partnership